01 / LAB OVERVIEW

Anonymous

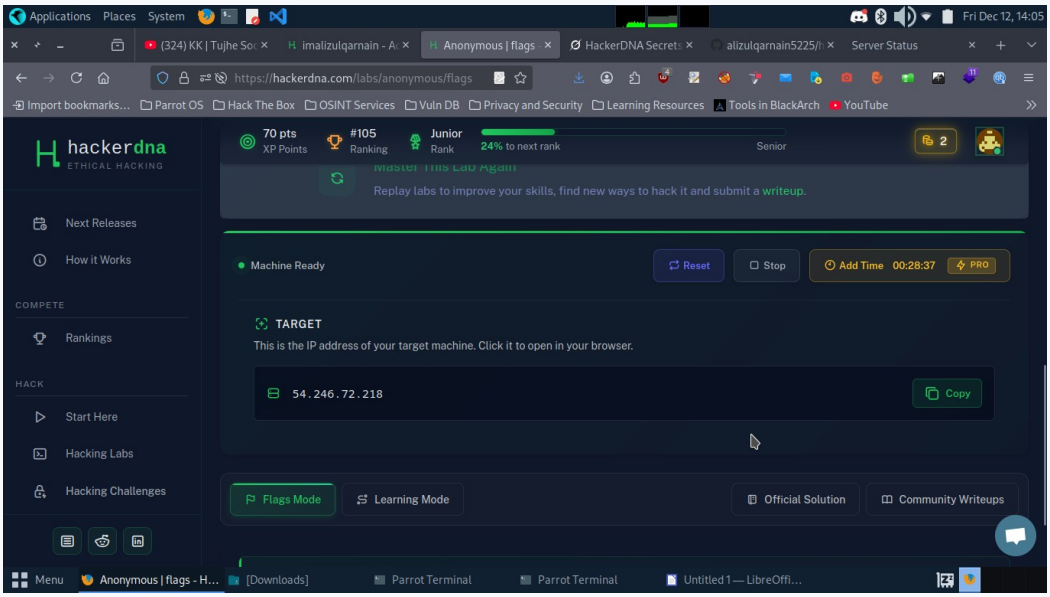
HackerDNA / Anonymous FTP access and file disclosure

English edition / Visual presentation: COMMANDO
A structured adaptation of the supplied walkthrough and its original screenshots.

Objective

Enumerate the target, identify an FTP service that accepts anonymous access, and download flag.txt. The challenge demonstrates how permissive file-service configuration can expose sensitive information without a private account.

Difficulty: Easy **Flags:** 1
Skills: Nmap, service enumeration, FTP access and file retrieval.



01. Original HackerDNA dashboard showing the running lab instance.

Start the lab

Open the Anonymous lab, start the instance, and copy its target IP. Keep the dashboard available for flag submission. The original session uses **54.246.72.218**; substitute the address assigned to your current instance.

Attack path

Service discovery → web inspection → anonymous FTP check → FTP login → directory listing → flag download.

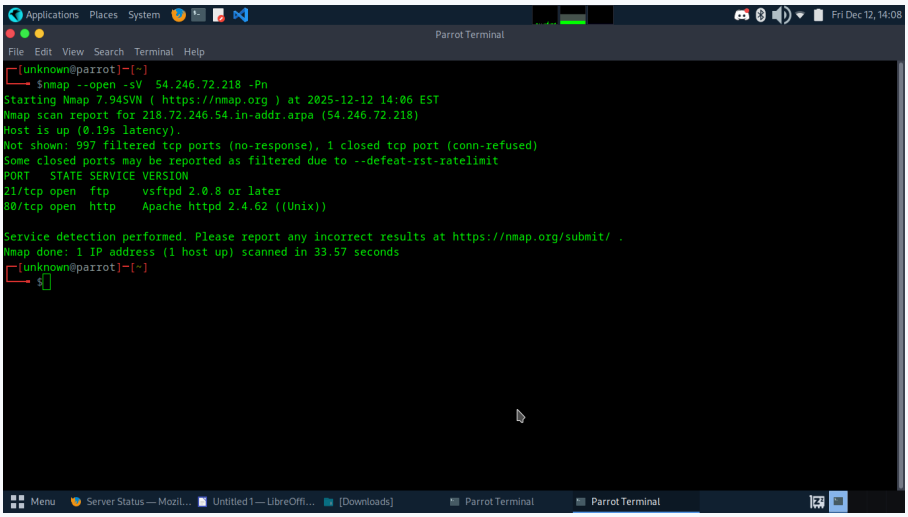
02 / RECONNAISSANCE

Identify the exposed services

Nmap results and a minimal HTTP page

```
nmap -sV -Pn <TARGET_IP>
```

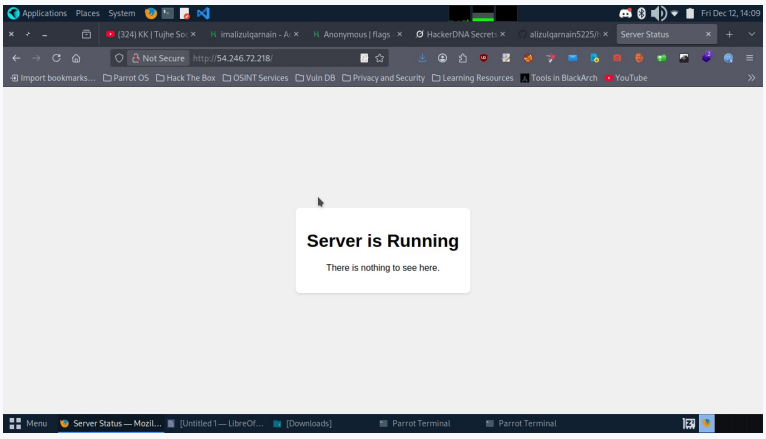
The recorded scan identifies **21/TCP (FTP)** and **80/TCP (HTTP)**. FTP becomes the main investigation target. The supplied prose and screenshot differ on the exact FTP version, so the attack does not rely on a specific version claim.



02. Original service scan showing FTP and HTTP.

Inspect the web service

Visit **http://<TARGET_IP>**. The page displays a basic server-status message, with no useful links or forms visible. Continue by examining the FTP service.



03. The web page provides only a minimal server-status message.

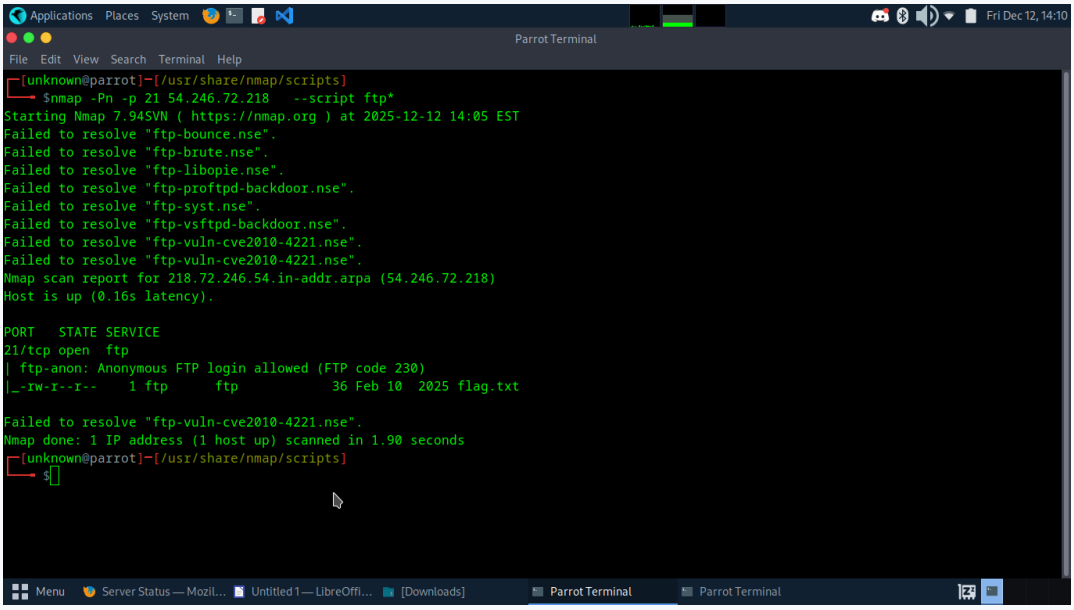
03 / FTP ENUMERATION

Confirm anonymous access

Check the configuration before downloading files

```
nmap -Pn -p 21 --script ftp-anon <TARGET_IP>
```

This focused command checks whether the server accepts anonymous FTP login and may list accessible files. It is a cleaned-up alternative to the broad ftp* script selection shown in the source.



04. Original enumeration output: anonymous login allowed and flag.txt listed.

Read the relevant result

```
Anonymous FTP login allowed (FTP code 230)
```

The screenshot includes script-name resolution errors, but it also records a successful anonymous-login result. FTP code **230** indicates that login succeeded. The directory listing exposes **flag.txt**.

Why this matters

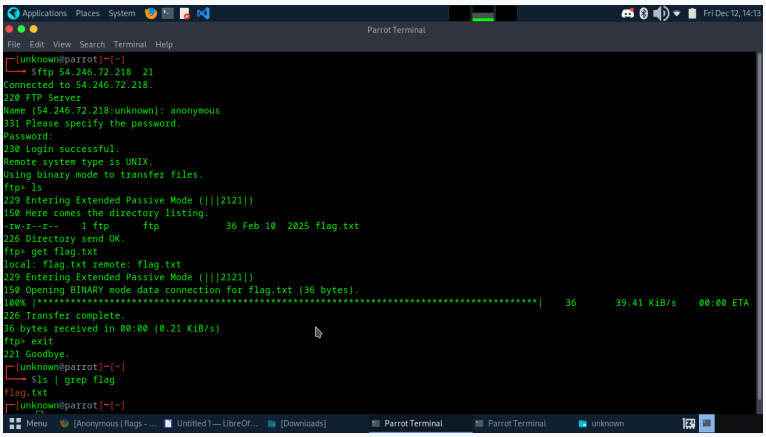
Anonymous FTP is intended for public access. The security failure occurs when that public account can read files that should remain private. No password cracking or software exploit is required for this path.

04 / FILE RETRIEVAL

Download and read the flag

FTP session, local verification and defensive lessons

```
ftp <TARGET_IP> 21
# Username: anonymous
# Password: anonymous
ls
get flag.txt
bye
# Local shell:
cat flag.txt
```



05. Original FTP session showing login, flag.txt retrieval and transfer completion.

The screenshot confirms login and a **36-byte** download. The password is not echoed. Read the file locally and submit the flag in the dashboard. Its contents are not shown in the supplied evidence.

Lessons learned

Enumerate every exposed service: a minimal web page does not mean the host has no useful attack surface. Verify anonymous access explicitly, inspect file permissions, and distinguish a successful transfer from reading the downloaded contents.

Defensive priorities

Disable anonymous FTP when unnecessary. If public downloads are required, isolate them from private files, grant only intended read access, and review the published directory regularly. Use an encrypted authenticated service for sensitive transfers.

Edition note: English wording refined and all five source screenshots retained. Commands were not re-executed for this edition.